Outlook

Game 9 Preview Vs Princeton at Charlottesville, Va | March 11, 2026

From Khan, Faizan Ikram Ur Rahim Khan (xdy6sg) <xdy6sg@virginia.edu>
Date Tue 3/10/2026 11:19 PM
To LaMonica, Sonia (nzf7be) <slamonica@virginia.edu>; LaMonica, Michael (zdc9tf) <mlamonica@virginia.edu>; Brady, Shanna Elizabeth (bpr8se) <sbrady@virginia.edu>; Glynn, Kady (nvt4du) <kglynn@virginia.edu>; Pell, Cecelia Elizabeth (qcs7ws) <cpell@virginia.edu>

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Princeton enters Charlottesville at 2-2 with elite senior talent but a glaring draw-control vulnerability that Virginia is built to exploit.

- The Tigers lost their all-time leading scorer McKenzie Blake and all-time draw specialist Sophie Whiteway to graduation, and
- The draw-circle deficit has been the defining storyline of their early season – losing draws **6-20** to Loyola and **8-21** to Maryland.
- The Tigers remain dangerous, however: they feature four preseason All-Americans, a senior goalkeeper averaging **11.25 saves per game**, and an attack duo in Jami MacDonald and Haven Dora that ranks among the nation's most productive.
- Virginia, now **4-4 (3-1 ACC)** after consecutive road wins at Pitt and Florida State, has momentum and owns the head-to-head series **24-19**, including wins in the last three meetings.

PRE-GAME WIN PROBABILITY MODEL

Feature-weighted logistic model · #20 Virginia vs #18 Princeton · Home game

VIRGINIA WIN PROBABILITY

55%

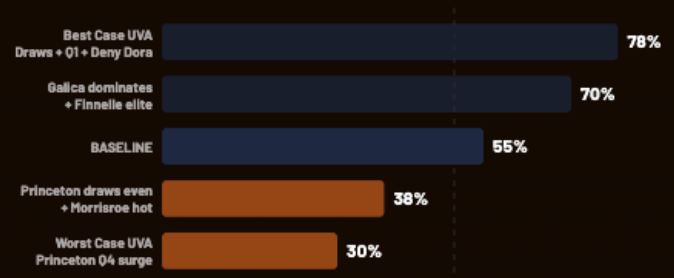
PRIN 45% | UVA 55%

MODEL INPUTS

Ranking gap: #20 vs #18 → nearly even, base ~50/50. **Home court:** Virginia at Klöckner → +5% UVA. **H2H 2025:** Virginia won 13-11 → +3% UVA. **Draw control:** Galica vs Princeton committee (massive mismatch) → +6% UVA. **Form:** UVA 4 of last 5 wins; Princeton 2-2 → +2% UVA. **GK:** Hughes elite → −4% UVA. **Talent depth:** Princeton 4 preseason All-Americans → −3% UVA. **Adjusted: Virginia 55%, Princeton 45%.**

SWING FACTOR SENSITIVITY

Galica wins 60%+ of draws	UVA 70%	+15% from baseline
Virginia scores 3+ in Q1	UVA 68%	+13% from baseline
Finnelle .500+ save %	UVA 62%	+7% from baseline
Virginia denies Dora's passing lanes	UVA 65%	+10% from baseline
Princeton wins draws (45%+)	UVA 40%	-15% from baseline
Morrisroe scores 5+ goals	UVA 38%	-17% from baseline
Hughes posts .550+ sv%	UVA 42%	-13% from baseline
Princeton wins Q4 by 3+	UVA 35%	-20% from baseline



1. Princeton's 2026 results reveal a team finding its identity

Game 1 — Feb. 21 at #19 Loyola Maryland: L, 10-14

- Princeton opened as the **last Division I team to play this season** (February 21), a scheduling quirk that created early-season rust.
- Here is every result with quarter-by-quarter scoring:

	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Final
Princeton	2	0	3	5	**10**
Loyola	2	9	1	2	**14**

- The season opener exposed Princeton's central weakness immediately.
  - After a 2-2 first quarter, Loyola ripped off a **9-0 second quarter run** that buried the Tigers.
  - Princeton rallied with an 8-3 second half - Meg Morrisroe scored all 5 of her goals after halftime but the damage was done.
    - Loyola dominated draws **20-6**.
    - GK Amelia Hughes made 12 saves.
    - MacDonald had 3G/2A.

Game 2 — Feb. 25 vs. Rutgers (Home): W, 15-9

	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Final
Rutgers	~1	~2	~3	~3	**9**
Princeton	~2	6	~4	~3	**15**

- The bounce-back win featured a **6-0 Princeton scoring run** in the second quarter that blew open an 8-1 lead.

- Morrisroe again led with 5G ; Maggie Molnar added a hat trick.
- Hughes had 12 saves (8 in the first half).
- Princeton still lost the draw battle **8-16** but won on finishing efficiency — shooting 6-for-10 in Q2.
- Juliana Williams had 2 caused turnovers, Abigail Roberts 3 ground balls.

Game 3 — Feb. 28 at #3 Maryland: L, 12-16

	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Final
Princeton	3	4	2	3	**12**
Maryland	7	2	3	4	**16**

- Princeton struck first with 2 quick goals from Maggie Bacigalupo, then Maryland unleashed a **7-0 run** to lead 9-3 early in Q2.
- The Tigers clawed back to 10-8 at half and got within 2 goals twice but couldn't complete the comeback.
- Maryland dominated draws **21-8** once again.
  - Bacigalupo had a career-high 4G.
  - Defender Dylan Allen scored her first career goal on a coast-to-coast clear.
  - Hughes made 11 saves.

Game 4 — Mar. 7 at Harvard (Ivy): W, 19-13

	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Final
Princeton	5	~6	~2	~6	**19**
Harvard	3	~3	~4	~3	**13**

- Princeton's best performance of 2026. MacDonald exploded for **4G/4A (8 points)**, reaching her **200th career point**.

- Morrisroe added 4G/ 3A.
- Haven Dora posted a career-high **6 assists** and,
  - a career-high **7 draw controls** the first sign that Princeton's draw issues may be stabilizing.
- Harvard cut the deficit to 3 in Q3 (13-10) before Princeton pulled away with 6 of the next 7 goals.
- Hughes made 10 saves. Princeton University Athletics

Scoring trends across all four games:

- Princeton has been outscored in first quarters and second quarters by opponents who apply early pressure the **9-0 Q2 run by Loyola and 7-0 Q1 run by Maryland** are the most alarming patterns.
- However, Princeton has outscored opponents in second halves in 3 of 4 games.
- **The Tigers are a second-half team that adjusts well but starts slowly.** They are most dangerous in Q4, scoring 5, ~3, 3, and ~6 goals respectively across their four games.

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2. The attack trio of Morrisroe, MacDonald, and Dora drives everything

Princeton's offense runs through three distinct weapons, each requiring a specific defensive response.

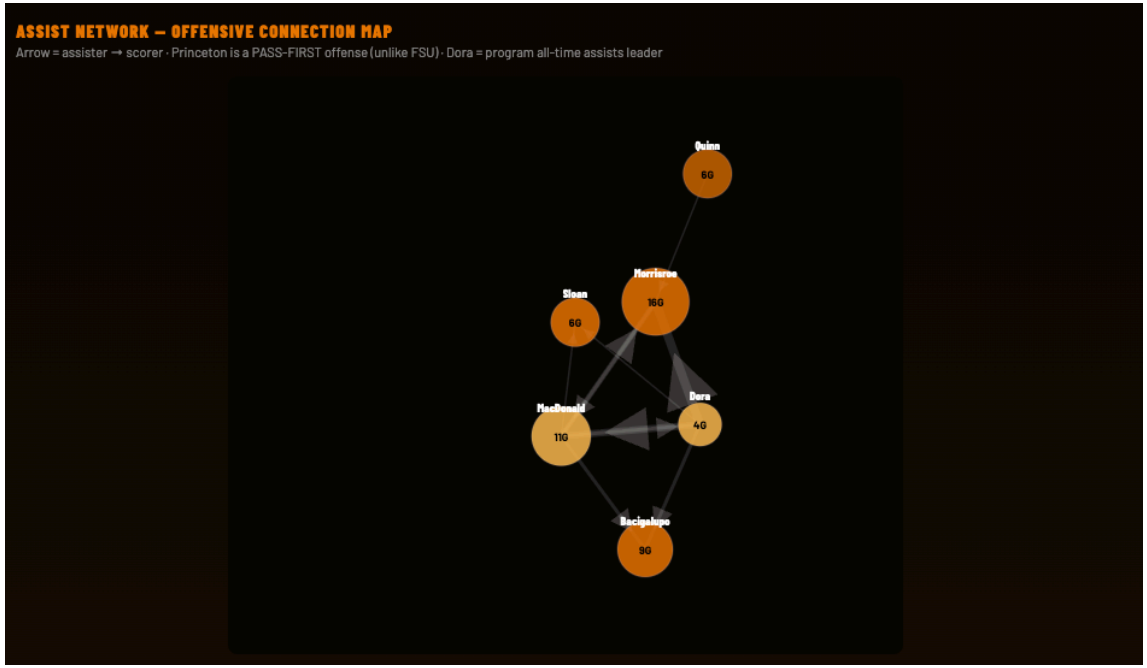
- **Dora is the offensive engine.** Program all-time assists leader (118+).
  - She operates from behind the cage and the wing, feeding Morrisroe and MacDonald.

Denying Dora's passing lanes is the single highest-leverage defensive action.

- **MacDonald is the secondary distributor.**
  - The MacDonald↔Morrisroe and MacDonald↔Dora connections are bidirectional.

Virginia cannot rely on man-to-man denial of individuals — we need to disrupt PASSING LANES through zone positioning and active hands.

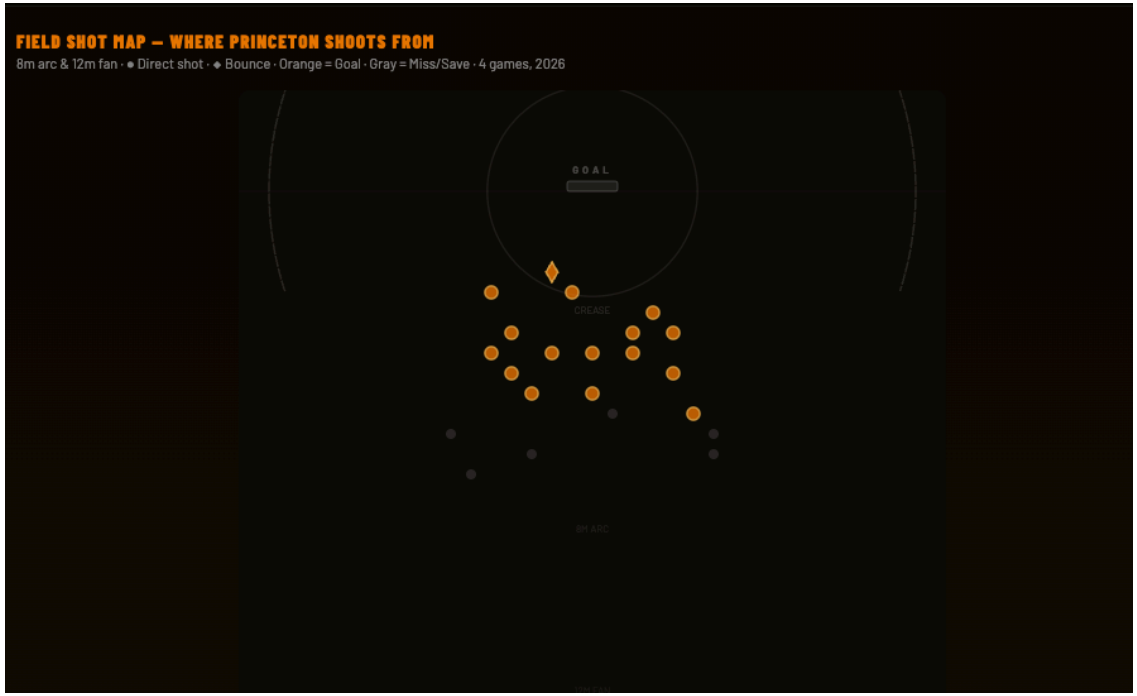
Pack the middle, force perimeter shots.



#3 Meg Morrisroe

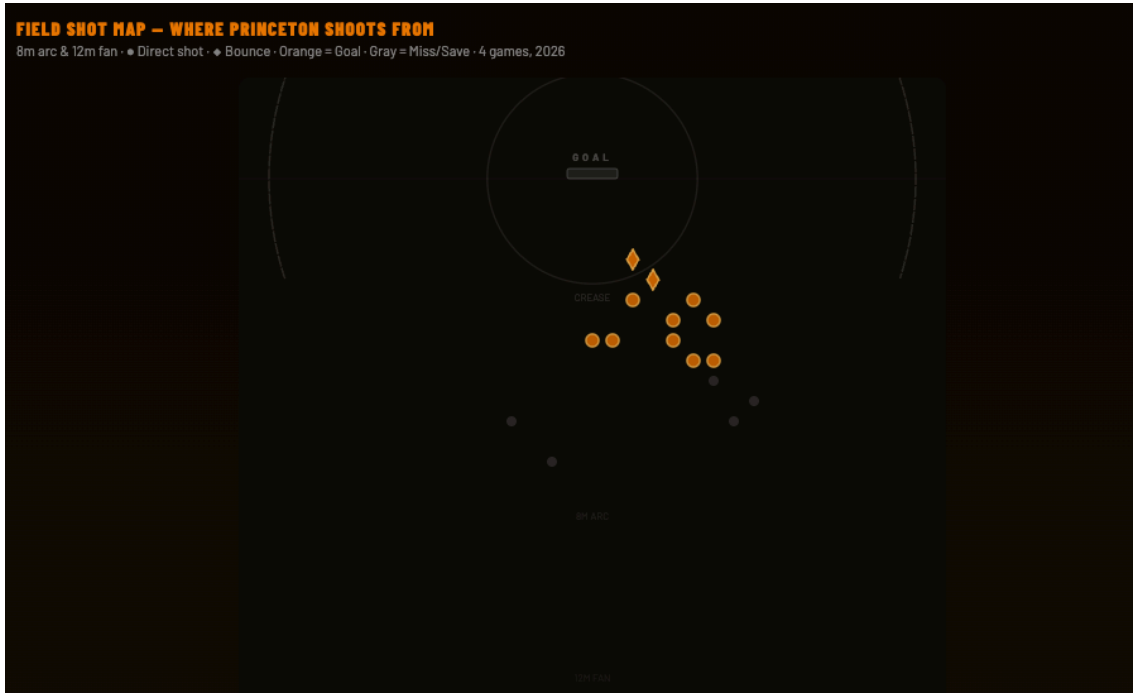
- The team's leading goal scorer has been on fire.
  - Through 4 games: approximately **16 goals, 3+ assists, 19+ points**. She shot **.632** through her first three games (12 goals on 19 shots and ranked **8th nationally in goals per game (4.0)**.
  - She is Princeton's most dangerous finisher -- fast release, comfortable from multiple angles

Virginia must account for Morrisroe as the primary scoring threat. **>>** Force her outside 12m and double on her in Q3/Q4.



#17 Jami MacDonald (C)

- MacDonald, through 4 games in 2026: approximately **9-11 goals, 8+ assists, 17-19 points**.
  - MacDonald is the most complete player on the roster ; she creates for herself and others, is deadly in settled situations, and elevates her game in big moments.
    - She had 3G/2A in the 2025 meeting vs. Virginia that Princeton lost 11-13.



#7 Haven Dora

- Princeton's **all-time career assists leader** is the engine of the offense.
  - Through 4 games in 2026: approximately **4G, 11+ assists, 15+ points**. Dora is primarily a facilitator - she also posted a career-high **7 draw controls** at Harvard, suggesting she is taking on draw specialist duties.

Disrupting Dora's passing lanes is the single most impactful thing Virginia's defense can do.

The Dora-to-MacDonald and Dora-to-Morrisroe connections are the primary passing lanes. MacDonald also creates for Morrisroe and vice versa

When these three players combine for 5+ assists in a game, Princeton wins.

Emerging scorers providing depth:

#	Player	Pos	2026 G	Notes
15	Maggie Bacigalupo	M	**9**	• Breakout : entered season with 3 career goals. • 4G vs Maryland, 3G vs Harvard
13	Ella Sloan	M	**6**	• Returned from missing all of 2025 (injury). • 4G at Harvard
5	Colette Quinn	M	**6**	• Consistent two-way mid. • 2G vs Rutgers, 2G vs Harvard

#	Player	Pos	2026 G	Notes
2	Maggie Molnar	M	**4**	• Hat trick vs Rutgers. • Free-position specialist (8-for-12 FP in 2025)

15 Maggie Bacigalupo

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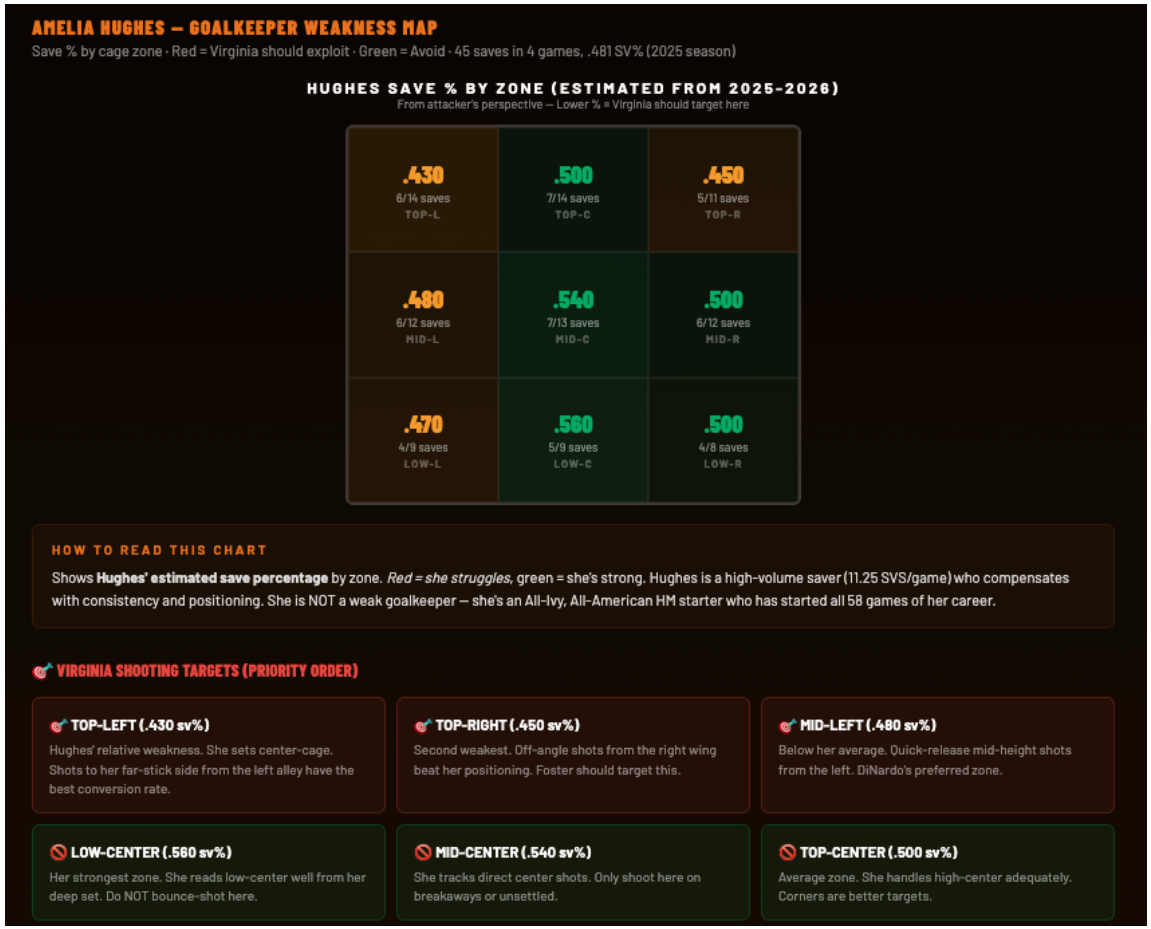
3. Amelia Hughes is a battle-tested wall in goal

#12 Amelia Hughes –

- Hughes has started **all 58 of Princeton's games** over her four-year career, every single one.
- She has recorded **double-digit saves in all 4 games this season**

Scouting Hughes –

- She sees a high volume of shots and thrives on activity ; Princeton's defensive scheme funnels shots to areas where Hughes is comfortable.
- She is better at stopping point-blank shots from the 8-meter than long-range attempts, based on the shot profiles in her game logs.



- **Hughes is NOT beatable by volume alone.**

  - **The key to beating Hughes is MOVEMENT and DECEPTION. Quick ball movement to create unsettled looks. Attack from the wings — she sets center-cage.**
  - **Avoid feeding her rhythm with predictable top-center shots.**
- **Free positions:**
  - **Hughes defends FPs well from her deep set. Use pump fakes and shot placement to corners rather than raw power.**

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4. Draw controls are Princeton's Achilles' heel

- The graduation of **Sophie Whiteway** - Princeton's all-time draw control leader with **249 career draws** - has left a void that may be the defining factor on March 11.

Draw control results by game:

Game	Princeton DCs	Opponent DCs	Result
at Loyola	**6**	20	L, 10-14
vs Rutgers	**8**	16	W, 15-9
at Maryland	**8**	21	L, 12-16
at Harvard	17	17	W, 19-13

Princeton has been demolished on the draw circle in 3 of 4 games.

- They lost the draw control battle 6-20, 8-16, and 8-21 in their first three games — winning only when their defense and finishing efficiency overcame the possession deficit .
- At Harvard, there were signs of improvement with Dora posting 7 draw controls, but the sample is small.

Who takes draws for Princeton now?

- The role is being split among Haven Dora, Colette Quinn, Ella Sloan, Maggie Bacigalupo, and Becca Kirschner

- Defender Abigail Roberts contributed 78 draw controls in 2025, so she factors in as well.
- But none of these players replicate Whiteway's dominance.

The correlation is stark:

- When Princeton loses draws badly, they lose games. When they can keep the margin manageable, their talent can carry them.

Virginia's Kate Galica should dominate this matchup.

If Galica wins draws at her season average, Virginia will control possession.

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5. Princeton's defense is experienced but has allowed scoring runs

Defensive personnel (all 4 starters return from 2025):

#	Player	2025 Stats	Role
—	**Dylan Allen (C)**	21. T, 24 GB	• Marks the opponent's best attacker. • Elite 1v1 defender and clearer • scored her first career goal vs Maryland on a coast-to-coast run.
1	**Abigail Roberts (C)**	78. C, 40 GB, 16 CT	• Transitions quickly; has 7 career goals on 11 shots.
10	**Zoe Bye**	10. T, 11 GB	• Lockdown coverage defender whose value is in denial — opponents avoid feeding into her area .
—	**Juliana Williams**	14. P/12 GS	• Developed significantly during 2025.

#	Player	2025 Stats	Role
			• Had 2 CT, 2 GB vs Rutgers in 2026.

Defensive scheme:

- Princeton operates primarily from **zone defensive looks** with the ability to switch to man.
- Coach Cook's background is as a defensive coordinator and her scheme funnels shots toward Hughes.
- Allen shadows the opposing team's primary attacker in man situations.
- Princeton ranked **4th nationally in clearing percentage in 2025** -- the ability to transition quickly from defense to offense through Allen and Roberts is a program hallmark.

Defensive vulnerabilities identified:

- Princeton has allowed **52 goals in 4 games (13.0 per game)** and has been susceptible to extended scoring runs.
- Loyola's 9-0 Q2 blitz and Maryland's 7-0 Q1 run suggest that **when Princeton's zone breaks down, it can collapse quickly.**
- Cook acknowledged this: "We've had stretches where we've lost focus, and at this level, even brief lapses can lead directly to goals or turnovers."

Fast ball movement and off-ball cuts designed to shift the zone are the best counter. Virginia should attack early — Princeton has been a slow-starting team that finds its rhythm in the second half.

How Virginia matches up against Princeton's style

- Princeton's offensive identity is **high-volume, balanced, motion-based attack** — they ranked 4th nationally in shots per game in 2025.
- They are not isolation-heavy; **they move the ball through Dora to create open looks for Morrisroe, MacDonald, and their midfield scorers.**

Virginia's three primary advantages:

- **Draw controls.** This is the matchup that could decide the game. Galica vs. Princeton's patchwork draw unit is a mismatch Virginia must exploit to create extra possessions.
- **Scoring runs.** Princeton has allowed a 9-0 run (Loyola Q2) and a 7-0 run (Maryland Q1) this season. Virginia's offense, which scored 7 unanswered against Pitt, is capable of delivering these knockout stretches.
- **Early-game pressure.** Princeton has been slow to start in all 4 games. Virginia should come out aggressive and try to build a lead before Princeton's second-half adjustment ability kicks in.

Princeton's advantages:

- **Individual offensive talent.** Morrisroe, MacDonald, and Dora are each capable of taking over a game. MacDonald just had an 8-point performance at Harvard. Virginia needs Allen-level individual matchups on at least two of these three.
- **Hughes in goal.** Her 11.25 saves per game will frustrate Virginia shooters. Virginia must be disciplined in shot selection.
- **Second-half adjustments.** Princeton has outscored opponents in the second half in 3 of 4 games. Even if Virginia leads at halftime, the game won't be over.

Conclusion: exploit the draw circle and attack early

- Princeton is a talented team in transition — still elite at the skill positions but searching for identity in the draw circle and trying to find the consistency that made them a 16-win Ivy champion a year ago.
- **The loss of Whiteway's 249 career draw controls and Blake's 89-goal season has fundamentally changed who Princeton is**, and they're not yet fully adjusted.
- Virginia's game plan should center on three priorities.
    - First, **win draws decisively** through Galica; every extra possession magnifies Virginia's improving offensive chemistry.
    - Second, **attack early and attack fast** ; Princeton's slow starts and vulnerability to scoring runs mean the first 15 minutes could set the tone for the entire game.

    - Third, **disrupt the Dora-MacDonald-Morrisroe passing triangle** through aggressive defensive positioning in passing lanes; if Dora can't distribute, Princeton's offense becomes far more predictable.

- The biggest risk for Virginia is complacency.
    - Princeton has shown it can come roaring back — the 8-3 second half run at Loyola and the rally from 9-3 down at Maryland demonstrate resilience.
    - Hughes will keep the Tigers in the game with double-digit saves.
    - And MacDonald, riding the high of her 200th career point, is playing her best lacrosse of the season.

This should be a close, competitive game between two ranked programs with deep history.

Virginia's draw-control advantage and home-field edge at Klöckner Stadium provide a meaningful margin, but Princeton's individual talent — particularly Morrisroe's scoring ability and Dora's vision — means Virginia cannot afford the defensive lapses that characterized its early-season losses.

Regards,
Faizan